

DH60 Gipsy Moth

In 1924 the British Air Ministry became interested in the structured development of flying clubs. Aware of the advantages of having an “air-minded” population, the Air Ministry proposed to make grants available to qualifying clubs for the purchase of approved types of light airplane. The aircraft had to be cheap to build, easy to fly, simple to maintain, robust, and reliable. One aircraft fitted the bill exactly—de Havilland’s immortal DH60 Gipsy Moth.

THE STORY of the DH60 Gipsy Moth is as much about its engine as its airframe. Although early DH60s were powered by a Cirrus I engine, it was the Gipsy that propelled the aircraft into history. A Gipsy Moth won the 1928 King’s Cup Race; one broke the 60 miles (97 km) closed circuit record; and another set an altitude record of 19,980 ft (6,909 m). A specially modified one even remained aloft for 24 hours.

However, it was a feat set by one particular engine that really got people talking. A Gipsy I was picked off the production line at random, installed in a Moth, and sealed by inspectors from the Air Inspection Directorate. It then flew 600 hours (a long time for an aero engine in the 1920s) between December 1928 and September 1929, while receiving only routine maintenance. At a stroke, de Havilland had demonstrated that its new aircraft was robust and its engine was also reliable.



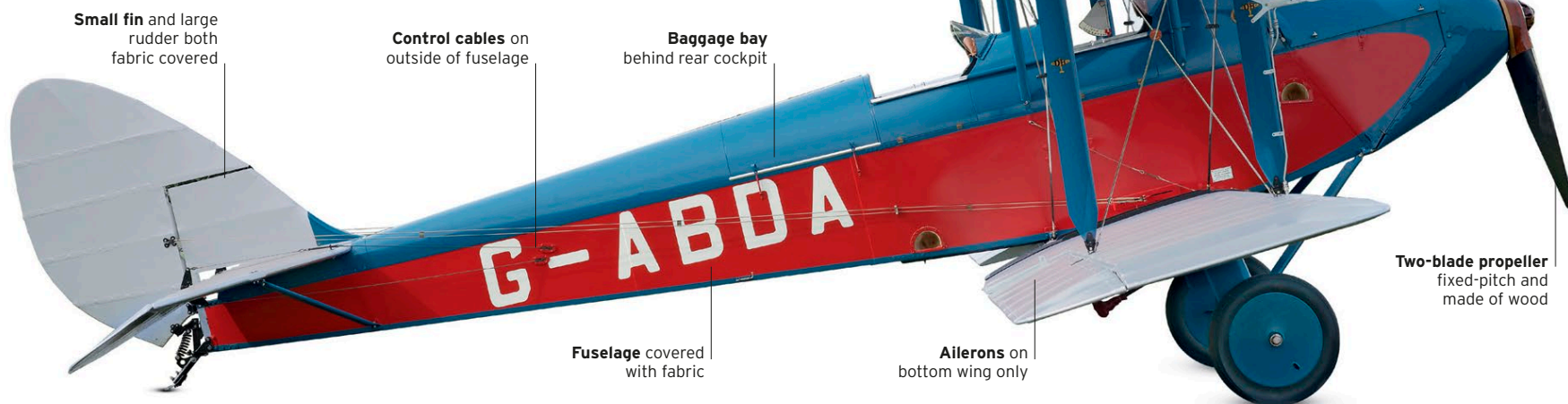
FRONT VIEW



REAR VIEW



SIDE VIEW WITH WINGS FOLDED BACK



Small fin and large rudder both fabric covered

Control cables on outside of fuselage

Baggage bay behind rear cockpit

Fuselage covered with fabric

Ailerons on bottom wing only

Two-blade propeller fixed-pitch and made of wood